EFFECTS OF GLOBALIZATION

The effects of globalization are difficult to discuss as some view globalization as the fruition of liberal economic principles, while some others are sceptical about it. The former perspective regards that a global marketplace has brought prosperity and growth, not to all, but positively to those integrated with the global market. They talk about dilution of state authority and highlight the importance of supranational institutions like the IMF, the World Bank and EU, and also the pre-eminence of transnational actors like the MNCs. The sceptics, on the other hand, regard the deepening of gap between the rich and the poor countries and their contention that the geographical distinction such as the North–South divide is disappearing in favour of a single global market is hardly tenable.[4] The world has witnessed series of protests and movements against globalization with its apparatus, especially those like the IMF and the World Bank, and the mantra of liberalization and privatization. The movement against globalization took a concrete expression in Seattle where thousands of people gathered to show their discontent against globalization during the annual WTO meeting in 1999. That was a significant beginning as, after Seattle meeting, there were series of movements across the globe at different times. Another significant protest was held in a big way in Genoa in 2001. From Seattle to Genoa is a long history of struggle against globalization, which has not yet died down and is still continuing. The world once again witnessed violent anti-G 20 protest in Toronto in Canada during the G-20 summit in June 2010. Police vehicles were set ablaze and windows of stores and banks were thrashed with stones and damaged by protestors.

Professor Bhagwati[5], in his *In Defense of Globalization*, points out that there are two groups of critics of globalization. He identifies as one of these two groups as hard-core protestors who have deep-seated antipathy towards globalization. Though they come from different intellectual and ideological backgrounds and do not share the same kind of sentiments, yet they have some commonness in their discontent, towards globalization. This discontent according to